Sarah Chen

Senior Software Engineer

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San Francisco, CA

SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 6 years of backend experience in Python and Go, including 3 years shipping LLM features to production. Designs retrieval pipelines and the offline evaluations that gate prompt and model changes.

EXPERIENCE

Fernway Payments | SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Jul 2024 – Present | San Francisco, CA

- Shipped a RAG support assistant (Python, FastAPI, pgvector) that resolves 38% of merchant tickets without handoff.
- Built an evaluation suite of 1,200 labeled conversations with LLM-as-judge and exact-match scorers; the team runs it in CI before merging prompt or model changes.
- Cut LLM spend by 46% by routing ticket classification to a fine-tuned 8B model and caching repeat queries in Redis.
- Rewrote the payout scheduling service in Go, raising throughput from 3k to 11k requests per second at a p99 latency under 120 ms.
- Led design reviews for a team of 6 and mentored 2 engineers through promotion to Software Engineer II.

Kestrel Health | SOFTWARE ENGINEER II

Apr 2022 – Jun 2024 | Seattle, WA

- Built a clinical note summarizer on Azure OpenAI with PHI redaction, used by 1,400 clinicians across 60 clinics.
- Developed the patient scheduling API in TypeScript and Node.js for 1.2M monthly users, and added contract tests that cut production incidents by 40% year over year.
- Implemented HIPAA audit logging and role-based access control across 12 internal services.

Bluepine Analytics | SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Jun 2020 – Mar 2022 | Seattle, WA

- Built Kafka ingestion workers in Python that process 500 GB of device telemetry per day for customer dashboards.
- Trained an Isolation Forest model in scikit-learn that flags sensor faults for 200 enterprise customers.

PROJECTS

promptdiff | CREATOR AND MAINTAINER github.com/sarahchen-dev/promptdiff **2024 – Present**

- Open-source Python CLI that runs a prompt test suite against two model versions and reports per-case regressions; 1.1k GitHub stars.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate

SKILLS

Python • Go • TypeScript • FastAPI • LLM Applications • RAG • LLM Evaluation • Fine-tuning (LoRA) • PyTorch • pgvector • PostgreSQL • Redis • Kafka • AWS • Kubernetes • Terraform

LANGUAGES

English (Native) • Mandarin (Professional)

EDUCATION

University of Washington
B.S. Computer Science
2016 – 2020

LINKS

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